Asia. Nearly three-quarters (seventy-three per cent) profess to practice their faith daily. Of the Buddhists, seventy-four per cent self-identify as devout, with the number of devout being fifty-five per cent for followers of other religions. This level of religious practice confirms long-standing findings of the prominence of religion in Myanmar life (see Smith 1965). The prominence of religion as a marker of identity extends to how Myanmar citizens understand citizenship. Respondents were asked to agree or disagree with the following statement: "Citizenship in Myanmar should be based on religion." A majority of eighty-one per cent agreed that citizenship should be based on religion, with a small minority disagreeing. Disproportionately those that agree that citizenship should be tied to religion are Buddhists. We also found that devout Buddhists were more likely to make this connection, at eighty-nine per cent compared to eighty per cent of non-devout Buddhists. Only forty-eight per cent of non-Buddhists supported citizenship based on religion, which is still a high number given that a minority faith would potentially be at a disadvantage to the majority faith.

Similar high responses for a political role for religion were given to questions involving secular government, with the majority of Myanmar citizens (sixty per cent) believing the government should consult religious authorities when making laws. Respondents were asked to agree or disagree with the following statement: "The government should consult religious authorities when interpreting the laws." A total of fourteen per cent disagreed, with sixteen per cent not answering this question. Of these respondents, devout Buddhists were more inclined to hold non-secular views. These numbers indicate the high prioritization given to religion in political life, especially among those with self-professed higher levels of religiosity.

The ABS did not ask directly about religious conflict. This was deemed too sensitive to be asked by the ABS-YSPS team. There are other questions in the survey that help us understand how religion shapes attitudes toward conflict. We can learn from the ABS questions on political culture. Over ninety per cent of respondents reported conflict-averse positions at the individual level. We also found that religion, notably more devout Buddhism, was associated with reported higher levels of intolerance. Over eighty per cent of devout Buddhists agreed that the society would be chaotic if people had too many different ways of thinking, reflecting less support for pluralism. Generally, stronger religious identity was